



The Pokemon Go Story

The backstory of how Pokémon Go came into existence! Don't miss this one if you're hooked to the game. digit.in/PokeGoStory



Apple Titan delayed?

Apple's Titan project, assumed to be a car, has been reported to be delayed till the year 2021. digit.in/ATitandelay



PERFORMANCE

CREATIVE SOUND BLASTER ROAR

The Sound Blaster Roar is the oldest among the three, but still provides decent audio. It does not remain the best in class any longer, but the five-driver setup still provides bright audio with excellent sound-staging. The placement of the bass drivers is an issue as you can never place it upright on a desk without muting the low frequencies. There is a significant amount of distortion here, and the overall audio balance is tipped towards the highs. Trebles are more pronounced, which is slightly bettered by switching on Tera Bass. At volume levels above 70 percent, there is a lot of audible distortion in tracks, particularly if you happen to be playing metal/progressive rock/grunge. The 'Roar' mode is incredibly loud, and this one is the loudest among the four, but this mode essentially compromises on quality of audio to deliver volume.



CREATIVE SOUND BLASTER ROAR 2

The Roar 2 sounds much cleaner, louder, brighter and warmer than the Sound Blaster Roar, although the company claims both the speakers use the same drivers and amplifier setup to deliver audio. The Roar 2 is not only versatile with its feature set, but is good with tracks ranging from electronica to alt and metal. The redesigned layout of the drivers have led to cleaner audio and much improved bass delivery, which now sound clean and powerful. However, the audio could have packed better clarity of mids, and the bass sounds loose in comparison to the UE Boom 2 and Beoplay A1. Tera Bass mode now somewhat overpowers tracks with bass, although Roar mode is much improved here. Tracks now sound louder alongside being less distorted, but you should not be using this mode unless you really need to blast the track across a large room.



ULTIMATE EARS BOOM 2

The UE Boom 2 sounds incredibly well-rounded for a portable Bluetooth speaker, delivering excellent balance of bass, mids and highs. The passive radiators deliver clean, tight bass which is not overpowering on the rest of the frequency range. Its cylindrical shape helps in omnidirectional audio delivery. The UE Boom 2's audio delivery is bright, warm and clean, with a sweetness in the audio timbre. The only qualms that we have here is the marginal distortion that kicks in at high volumes, especially when you are playing heavy metal tracks like Judas Priest's Beyond the Realms of Death. The Boom 2 also favours the highs more in higher volume levels, and in an attempt to pronounce the mids simultaneously, ends up compromising on the tight, powerful bass delivery that forms the backbone of its commendable audio performance, at about 75-80 percent volume levels.



B&O BEOPLAY A1

The Beoplay A1 further exceeds the expectations that the UE Boom 2 already shatters. The audio performance here is great, with best in class clarity, great balance of the frequency range, and excellent bass delivery. While the low frequencies sound a bit higher than the rest, it adds to the tightness of its audio delivery. The highs are sharp, the mids are very well balanced, and the Beoplay A1 does well in relaying excellent detail of audio, along with the warm and sweet timbre of audio that makes this the perfect speaker to play Beethoven's Moonlight Sonata. It does equally well, when you decide to switch to Iron Maiden's Dance of Death. The highs are a tad too sharp on the Beoplay A1, but they do not sound shrill and disruptive. The overall weight of the audio makes up for the shortcomings of the Beoplay A1, making it the best performing premium Bluetooth speaker that we have tried out of late.

Performance

Loudness.....	9.4/10
Range.....	7.8/10
Distortion.....	6.5/10
Test tracks -	
Skyfall by Adele.....	8/10
Hey You by Pink Floyd.....	8.4/10
Score.....	79/100

Performance

Loudness.....	9.2/10
Range.....	8.3/10
Distortion.....	7.5/10
Test tracks -	
Skyfall by Adele.....	8.2/10
Hey You by Pink Floyd.....	8.6/10
Score.....	83/100

Performance

Loudness.....	9/10
Range.....	9/10
Distortion.....	8.2/10
Test tracks -	
Skyfall by Adele.....	8.8/10
Hey You by Pink Floyd.....	9.1/10
Score.....	88/100

Performance

Loudness.....	8.4/10
Range.....	9.2/10
Distortion.....	9.5/10
Test tracks -	
Skyfall by Adele.....	9/10
Hey You by Pink Floyd.....	9.5/10
Score.....	92/100